

Distribution & Monetization Strategy

— n8n-nodes-baramundi-management-solution

Audience: Senior Product Manager, baramundi software GmbH **Purpose:** Alternative distribution paths and monetization options for the n8n connector **Date:** 2026-04-01

Alternative Distribution Paths

1. Public npm (current plan)

Free, globally discoverable, zero friction for end users. The standard community node path. No revenue, maximum reach.

2. Private npm Registry

Companies like JFrog Artifactory, Verdaccio, GitHub Packages, or AWS CodeArtifact can host a **private** npm registry.

How it works: - baramundi publishes the connector to their private registry - Customers configure their self-hosted n8n to point at that registry via the `NPM_CONFIG_REGISTRY` environment variable - Only customers with registry credentials can install it

Implication: This only works for **self-hosted n8n**. n8n Cloud uses the public npm registry exclusively and cannot be pointed elsewhere.

3. Manual Installation (No npm at all)

For self-hosted n8n, there are two bypass paths that don't require npm at all:

Option A — Custom extensions directory: n8n reads the `N8N_CUSTOM_EXTENSIONS` env variable pointing to a folder with pre-built node packages. baramundi could ship the `dist/` folder directly to customers as a download — ZIP file, customer extracts it, done.

Option B — Pre-built Docker image: baramundi ships a Docker image based on the official n8n image with the connector pre-installed. Customers run that image instead of the official one. Zero installation steps for the customer.

4. Contribute to n8n Core (Official Node)

n8n GmbH maintains the core set of "built-in" nodes (HubSpot, Slack, GitHub, etc.). These are different from community nodes — they are **part of n8n itself**, verified, and prominently featured.

To get there: submit a pull request to the n8n repository with the connector. n8n GmbH reviews and merges it. The node then ships with every n8n installation worldwide — no installation step for users at all.

Barrier: n8n has strict quality criteria. The connector would need to meet their node design guidelines. Given the 100% API coverage and existing quality, this is achievable.

Strategic value: Maximum visibility. baramundi appears alongside Salesforce, Microsoft, and SAP in the default n8n node library.

5. n8n Verified Community Node Program

A middle ground between "anonymous community node" and "official built-in node." n8n reviews the package and awards a **Verified badge** on npmjs.com and in the n8n UI.

Verified nodes appear higher in search results and carry a trust signal. Free to apply, requires n8n review.

6. n8n Template Marketplace

Separate from the node itself — n8n has a **workflow template marketplace** at n8n.io/workflows. Pre-built workflow templates using the baramundi connector could be published there.

This is a distribution channel for use cases, not for the node itself. Drives adoption by giving customers ready-made automations.

Monetization Strategies

Model A — Open Core / Freemium

Publish a **free "Community Edition"** connector with partial API coverage (e.g. read-only operations). A **"Professional Edition"** with full coverage requires a license key.

The pro version validates the license at runtime against a baramundi license server. Without a valid key, write/execute operations throw an error.

Revenue mechanism: License key sold via baramundi's existing sales channel, bundled with bMS Enterprise tier, or as a standalone add-on.

Risk: MIT license on the current codebase means the community could fork it and strip the license check. The freemium version must be published under a more restrictive license.

Model B — Bundled with bMS License

The connector is not sold separately — it is a feature of the **baramundi Management Suite product itself**.

- Customers with a bMS license get access to the connector package
- The connector validates the bMS license at runtime (calls the bMS license server or checks a JWT token from the credential)
- No valid bMS license = connector refuses to run

This is actually already partially set up: the connector authenticates against bConnect, which already requires a bMS installation. No separate monetization infrastructure needed.

Strategic fit: Positions the connector as a product feature, not a side project. Goes into the bMS product sheet.

Model C — Professional Services

The connector is free and open. baramundi (or certified partners) charge for:

- Workflow design and implementation consulting
- "baramundi Automation Starter Pack" — pre-built workflow templates sold as professional services deliverables
- Training and certification for baramundi administrators
- Custom connector extensions for enterprise-specific workflows

This is the model used by many enterprise OSS vendors. The software is free; the expertise is not.

Model D — OEM / ISV Licensing

License the connector to **Managed Service Providers (MSPs)** or **ISVs** who offer baramundi-based managed services to their customers. They embed the connector in their own tooling or offer it as part of their service package.

Revenue: per-seat or per-MSP licensing fee.

Model E — n8n Partnership

n8n GmbH has a **Technology Partner Program**. Partners get:

- Co-marketing (listed on n8n's integration page)
- Access to n8n's enterprise customer base
- Potential for being featured in n8n's workflow marketplace

This is not direct revenue from the connector itself, but generates **pipeline for bMS** — n8n enterprise customers become aware of baramundi.

Strategic Recommendation Matrix

Strategy	Revenue	Effort	Reach	Best for
Public npm (free)	None	Done	Maximum	Brand awareness, community adoption
Bundled with bMS license	High (indirect)	Low — auth already exists	bMS customers only	Existing customer upsell
Freemium (free + pro)	Medium	High — needs license server	All n8n users	New customer acquisition
Professional services	High	Medium	Enterprise customers	Large deployments
	None		Maximum	

Strategy	Revenue	Effort	Reach	Best for
Official n8n node		Medium — n8n review process		Long-term brand positioning
OEM/MSP licensing	Medium	Medium	MSP market	Channel sales
n8n partnership	None direct	Low	n8n enterprise base	Lead generation

The Key Insight

The connector authenticates via bConnect credentials, which already requires a **valid bMS installation**. This means **every user of the connector is already a bMS customer or prospect**. The connector is inherently a product feature, not a standalone product.

The strongest monetization angle is probably **Model B (bundled with bMS)** — position it as "baramundi Management Suite now integrates natively with n8n" in marketing, and let the existing bMS license gate access. No separate billing infrastructure, no community fork risk, and it becomes a **competitive differentiator** in bMS sales conversations against competing UEM vendors who have no n8n integration.